

卫生间 Toilets



DAILY BREAKS

We make up to 2½ pints (1.5 liters) of urine every day—enough to fill half a dozen coffee cups. When your bladder is full, nerve endings in the bladder's muscle wall signal to the brain that it is time for a bathroom break. A sphincter muscle keeps your bladder shut until you are ready to pee. The sphincter muscle relaxes and the bladder contracts to help push the urine out.

WOW!

Your hardworking kidneys make up just 1 percent of your weight, but they consume 25 percent of your body's oxygen.



OTHER JOBS

Your kidneys don't just filter and clean blood to make urine. They help control your blood pressure to make sure it stays within safe limits. Your kidneys also release a hormone (chemical messenger) that increases the production of red blood cells in your bones. What's more, they activate vitamin D made by the action of sunlight on the skin. Active vitamin D is needed in the body to make sure that bone-building calcium is absorbed from the small intestine.

FAST FACTS

- Every minute of the day, about a quart (liter) of blood passes through your kidneys to be filtered and cleaned.
- It takes less than an hour to clean your entire blood supply.
- Each kidney contains around one million tiny filtration and urine-making units called nephrons.
- In an average lifetime, the kidneys process 12 million gallons (45 million liters) of blood, enough to fill 18 Olympic-size swimming pools.

KIDNEY MACHINE

Sometimes the kidneys stop working properly due to disease. One solution is to transplant a healthy kidney into the body of a person with failing kidneys. But this isn't always possible. Kidney dialysis is an alternative treatment, which cleans a patient's blood by passing it through a machine that acts like an artificial kidney.

